

other families. We have four children, three boys and a girl, and it has always been fascinating to me that we have four exact opposites. What works with one certainly doesn't work with all.

I suppose I have counseled hundreds of couples with children, at one time or the other. Most of them wanted me to teach their children the biblical principles of handling money because the kids were having problems. The thing I remind them is: it is not my responsibility to teach their children, nor is it the church's responsibility or even the school's responsibility. God laid that responsibility squarely on the parents, and they can't avoid it.

The way to train your children is actually very simple. It's a principle given in the Proverbs that would translate, "As God is to the parents, so the parents should be to their children." In other words, whatever principles God establishes for the parents, the parents should pass along to their children. That seems easy enough. The difficulty comes in deciding which principles to teach at what age and how to get your children to understand. Hopefully, this discussion will help you to get started when you have children. Remember, the lessons you teach them will have to guide them through a complicated society in what is rapidly becoming a "perverse" generation.

TRAIN UP A CHILD

God's Word says, "Train up a child in the way he should go, even when he is old he will not depart from it" (Proverbs 22:6). The percentage of divorcees within the church is estimated to be between 30 and 40 percent of the total church congregation in America. If this trend continues at the same rate, by the year 2000, divorced people will represent 50 percent, and by about 2025 they will constitute more than 60 percent of the church. So Christians aren't immune to divorce, including the children of Christians.

I am always mindful of the people that I have counseled, because they mean so much to me. Often, as I think back over the years, God brings to mind those people who have been so